



THE GLITTERING WATERS OF LAKE TITICACA—the highest

TAQUILEÑOS

LIVING AT THE TOP OF THE WORLD

navigable lake in the world—span the border between Peru and Bolivia. On the Peruvian side is a small but very beautiful island called Taquile, which

Island in the sun

Taquile is an enchanting place whose exquisite setting and gentle way of life attract more and more tourists every year. There are fishermen and farmers here, but most people make their living from the tourist industry. Society is completely communal on Taquile, and everyone, whatever they do, shares in any profits the visitors bring.



BUSY NEEDLES

Textile crafts provide considerable tourist income for the Taquileños, and many elements of their traditional dress (which they wear every day) are hand made on the island as well. Knitting forms a major part of this heritage—but only the men do it. Here, an industrious worker is turning out one of the stocking caps, or *chulos*, worn by adult males—with red pom-poms if they are married, and white ones if they are single.

THE LANGUAGE OF DRESS

Like the men, the women of Taquile reveal their marital status through their clothing—navy or black skirts if they are married, brightly colored ones if they are not. Heavily embroidered waist sashes are common to both sexes.

ANCIENT ARCHWAY

The main entrance to Taquile is through a graceful archway over 500 steps up from the lake and harbor below. This arch, like most of the paths, ruins, and terraces on the island, is made from warm, reddish local stone.

